Now · Next · Later Roadmap

Show what you're working on, what's coming and what you're exploring, tied to goals, without promising dates you can't keep.

Decide What to Build · Now / Next / Later (Janna Bastow, ProdPad) · Outcomes, Not Dates

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

PRODUCT: Online grocery
OWNER: Priya
UPDATED: 6 June

1 Goals — WHY

GOAL A
Make the weekly shop effortless
Measure: repeat orders 30%

GOAL B
Nobody forgets an item
Measure: 2nd orders under 5%

GOAL C
Checkout is quick and trustworthy
Measure: drop-off under 12%

2 Now — COMMITTED · HIGH CERTAINTY

- Substitutes in all 12 stores
- Reminders for usual items
- Wallet payments

3 Next — SHAPED · MEDIUM CERTAINTY

- Subscriptions (if the pilot works)
- "You usually buy" list
- Faster checkout

4 Later — EXPLORING · LOW CERTAINTY

- Family accounts
- Recipe-to-basket
- Smart shopping list
- Saved cards across devices

CERTAINTY FALLS FROM LEFT TO RIGHT · LATER HOLDS PROBLEMS, NOT PROMISES

5 Not Doing — AND WHY · SAYING NO OUT LOUD

ITEM	WHY NOT (FOR NOW)
Personalised offers	no clear customer need yet
Voice ordering	few customers ask for it
Rebuild checkout	fix the slow parts instead

6 Assumptions to Test — BEFORE IT MOVES LEFT

WE BELIEVE…	WE'LL TEST IT BY
families keep subscriptions	the 50-customer pilot
reminders don't annoy	email 500 customers
wallets cut drop-off	a test with 10% of users

7 Review & Share — A LIVING PLAN

We review this every: month, after the review
Next review: 4 July
An item moves to Now when: it's shaped and a team has room (its assumptions tested)
Shared with: the whole company, on the wiki

- [x] Every item links to a goal
- [x] No dates beyond Now

"Which goal does this serve, and how will we know it worked?"

"What would have to be true for this to move from Later to Next?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit